

Chapter 10 / Mata o Muna 10: Fish and Fishing / Ika mo te Faiva

Bilingual Edition — Tuvalu Language & English

Tuvaluan (Tuvalu Language)

English

Mata o Muna 10

Chapter 10

Ika mo te Faiva

Fish and Fishing

A te fai ika, he mea e tāua kī i te olaga faka Nanumea. E hē gata ake a tona aogā pelā me he meakai telā e fakaaogā i pō katoa e tino Nanumea, kae ko te faitu e tahi he auala e tahi tenei e fakaali i ai a te takutakua mo te aogā o tāgata takitokotahi mō te fenua. A tautai kolā e maua e lātou a ika e uke mai te moana e mafai o lauiloa a lātou. A lātou hoki kolā e ma'hala i te aogā o te uāniu, me ko te poto i te haga i te talo, kae mafai e lātou o ofo atu mō te fenua.

Fishing was so important in the traditional life of Nanumea! Not only did fishing provide the protein (te kinaga) that was eaten everyday by Nanumean families, but it also provided a way for men to demonstrate publicly their importance to the community. A tautai who regularly brought back large catches of fish from the open ocean could become famous. Expert cultivators who shared large quantities of coconuts, taro or pulaka with the community could also win renown and praise.

A te mea tāua e tahi e gali i ai a te olo tele ki moana, o hīhīatu ia me o lalama, me fai pelā me he fakamalosiga o foitino o tamatane i te mea tenei ko te aloalo o te vaka i moana.

Another benefit of ocean fishing, whether for tuna or flying fish, was that it strengthened the bodies of young men who paddled the canoes out to sea.

A te mata o muna tenei e kāmata ki te fakamauga o vaegā faiva valevale kolā e fakaaogā i Nanumea, pelā hoki mo mea e māhani o fai i ai a faiva konei: te moana lahi, te kaupapa/uluulu mo te namo. Ka e mafai hoki o maua a fakamatalaga o faiva takutakua e tolu penei: te hīhī atu, te hele pāla, mo te lalama. E i ai hoki mo muna a te vaevaega o ika valevale, ki te fāoa mo te tautai.

This chapter begins by listing the many kinds of specialized fishing techniques used in Nanumea to catch the fish that frequent particular locations, such as the open ocean, the reef flats and the lagoon. Detailed descriptions are also provided for three distinctive fishing techniques: those used for skipjack/bonito tuna, for kingfish, and for flying fish.

Ka e fakaoti a te mataupu tenei mo he fakamatalaga a vaega fauga o pā, ni maua mai a Tangisia Kilei i a Okitopa 2006.

The chapter ends with an addition we received from Tangisia Kilei in October 2006 describing the tying of pearl shell lures.

Faiva e Fakaaogā e Tāgata Nanumea

Types of Fishing Practiced in Nanumea

E uke a vaegā ika valevale e mafai o maua i te tai pelā mo te moana, kaupapa/uluulu mo te namo. Konei a igoa o vaegā faiva valevale e mafai o fakaaogā:

Many different fish are found in the various marine environments of the open ocean, the reef flats, and the lagoon. Here are some names of fishing techniques used in each of these places:

Faiva i te Moana

Fishing in the Ocean

fakatūtū futifuti tau malau haehae hana hele pāla hīhī atu takitaki hīhī humu holoaki lalama tatakī lu tafauli lu takuo tatativi tuiaki

fakatūtū futifuti tau malau haehae hana hele pāla hīhī atu takitaki hīhī humu holoaki lalama tatakī lū tafauli lū takuo tatativi tuiaki

Faiva i te Uluulu/Papa

Fishing on the Reef

fagota faitili hana helele hīhī kalo hīhī patuki hīhī taiva hīhī tute kalafi ula laumaga naonao pei malau ponopono seu lupo seu ulua taa tītī hīhī puhi keli kahi keli hahule hohola pohina hohola matakaviki

fagota faitili hana helele hīhī kalo hīhī pātuki hīhī taiva hīhī tute kalafi ula laumaga naonao pei malau ponopono seu lupo seu ulua tā tītī hīhī puhi keli kahi keli hahule hohola pohina hohola matakaviki

Faiva i te Namu

faga puhi faifeke faitili fakatū tili fakatūtū hana
hele koile hīhī lafalafa hīhī talaloa lafolafa lama
lafalafa takitaki taumānu ukuuku utogi velo fonu
velo hue hīhī nanue hīhī ngatala pepeī hōpū nao
'kohi

Fishing in the Lagoon

faga puhi faifeke faitili fakatū tili fakatūtū hana
hele koile hīhī lafalafa hīhī talaloa lafolafa lama
lafalafa takitaki taumānu ukuuku utogi velo fonu
velo hue hīhī nanue hīhī ngatala pepeī hōpū nao
'kohi

Hīhī Atu

A te hīhī atu he faiva e lahi te fakaaogā kae
fakatāua e tāgata Nanumea i pō mua, telā e fakavae
mālosi ki ai a te ola a ona tāgata. Ko te faiva hoki
tenei e lavea i ai a te takatakua a ona tāgata (tautai),
kolā e ofo atu a olotou ika ke fakaaogā me ke tufa ki
te fenua katoa. I taimi kolā e 'kai a te fenua ki uta i te
āhiga ia me ko te taimi e 'lau i ai a pā a tautai.

A tautai kolā koa māhani i te faitega o pā, koa mafai
ailoa e lātou o lavea a te hekeheke o lanu o tifa o
fenua valevale manafai e fakafua a olotou pā.

Fishing for Bonito/Skipjack Tuna

Pole fishing for skipjack tuna was widely practiced
and valued by Nanumeans in traditional times, and
was an important part of men's lives. In this type of
fishing, canoe captains could become famous by
distributing their large catch to the entire community.
On those occasions, the whole community would
gather to eat in the āhiga, celebrating that the pearl
shell lure of the canoe captain had caught one
hundred or more tuna.

Canoe captains were skilled in making pearl shell
lures (pā). They paid attention to the differing colors
of pearl shell from different places when they made
their lures. However, the Nanumea pearl shell,
yellowish with the colors of a pigeon-feather running
through the middle, is especially attractive to
skipjack tuna.

Nohoaga o te Faoa mo Igoa o Kiato

A te tautai ko ia telā e pule i te vaka kaiva. Nohoaga
i loto i te vaka e penei:

- Foe mua: ki mua o te vaka
- Foe loto: i te galoto kae ki mua
- Kaukau: i te galoto kae ki tua
- Tautai (telā e ona te vaka): ki tua loa

Seats of the Crew and the Names of their Struts

The captain is in charge of his ocean-going fishing
canoe and he selects the crew he wants to
accompany him. There are four seating positions in
the canoe:

- Foe mua: at the front of the canoe
- Foe loto: a little forward of the midpoint
- Kaukau: a little behind the midpoint
- Tautai: at the far back (he is the canoe owner)

Te Faiga o te Hīhī Atu

A te faiva tenei, atu lā ko te itulā e 3-4 i te vaveao,
kae koa fano a te tautai o 'hala a tona fāoa, i te taimi
ailoa telā koi logotonu i ai a te moe. E mafai e
tamātane o fakaloiloi e lātou a tautai, me ia te ia e
mahaki, ia me fakalavelave. Telā lā e tai faigatā hoki
ailoa a te galuega tenei ko te 'halaga o te fāoa, kae
tafaga atu lā a tautai koi fakakoako.

Kae fai koa maua a te fāoa, ko te mea hoki ailoa koa
fakatoka o olo, hiki a te vaka ki tai, hao ki moana i
loto i te ava Amelika. E hē leva hoki ko te mea ailoa
koa pakē mai tua. Puke atu a te kaukau ki te foe a te
tautai, kae koa tū ake. Moe i loto a te atuō. Lua, tolu,
fā ko te mea ailoa, koa hē iloa me koa fia.

Going out to Hīhī Atu

Around 3:00 to 4:00 in the pre-dawn, the tautai goes
to assemble his crew, a time when they are sound
asleep. Some young men might try to avoid going
out, saying they don't feel well or are busy. As a
result, the task of assembling a crew can be quite
difficult for the tautai, even though he has previously
taught them well. However, if they know for sure that
schools of bonito are just offshore, it is a lot easier
for the young men to head out to sea.

Once the crew has been awakened they prepare to
leave, carrying the canoe to the shore and then
paddling out through the American ocean pass. It is
not long until there is noise from behind. The kaukau
takes the tautai's paddle and the canoe comes to a
stop. They are right in the midst of the atuō, the
school of bonito. The kaukau reaches down—two,
three, four bonito! Amazing! Who knew how many?

E hē māhāni o penei a te akau i taimi katoa kae atu lā e hē motuhia koa manuia o te nohoaga, tenei koa manuia i ai a te fenua penei. E lahi a te umitigina e tino Nanumea te ika tenei, kae hili i ai ko te ota.

The bonito shoals are not always like this. But without doubt, when things are all in good order within the community, the island will be favoured this way. Nanumeans crave bonito fish, especially to eat raw.

Hele Pāla

He faiva hoki e tahi tenei e fakaogā e tautai i tafa o te tuiaki (taki) pāla. E tai fakaofogina a te faiva tenei ko te hele pāla me koa hē fagai ki te gutu, kae koa hele a te magamaga o te ika. E hē lahi a te fakaogā o te faiva tenei heiloga e i ai he pāla e tū ki te vaka, ka e iloga hoki ailoa a tautai e apo i te faiga o te faiva tenei.

Mai tai malie ailoa i mata o te nifo, i mo mea ailoa o te takiga-a-pāla. Ko te malōga hoki ailoa ki tua, lāve ki tua a te pāla. Hē leva ko te mea ailoa koa hau i lalo o te vaka a te pāla. Muna a te tautai, "Koa moe i loto i te umu a te pāla nei." Ko te mea ailoa koa mafuli mai ki te tolu o ane, ko te uluga hoki ailoa ki loto i te kupega kae koa kamata a te tautai o gagafa tahi,.. lua.. tolu.., kae fiti.

Noosing Kingfish (Pāla)

This type of fishing for kingfish is also used by some tautai in addition to hook fishing. It is an unusual way of fishing since it does not involve catching the fish with bait, but rather noosing the tail of the fish. This manner of fishing cannot be used unless the fish is right under the canoe, but it is known to tautai experienced in fishing for pāla.

Just a little seaward of "the Tooth," the pāla is resting behind, moving back, while above the tuiaki bait is being prepared. Before long, the kingfish has moved under the canoe. The tautai then counts, "One, two, three." Then struggling is felt. The noose is tight around the tail of the kingfish. This is how the fishing technique of hele pāla is done.

Lalama

E tenei hoki a te faiva e tahi e māhāni o fakaogā e te tokoukega a tāgata Nanumea. Ko te ika tenei ko te hahave e taulahi 'ki i te moana o Nanumea, telā lā koa mafai o fai pelā me he kiki māhāni o mo meakai. Kae fai e i ai he mate (fakataufai i hoa) faka te fenua e fai, a te 'have o te pō tenā e 'kave katoa ki te āhiga o tufa mā te fenua.

Fishing for Flying Fish (Hahave)

This is another kind of fishing practiced by the majority of Nanumean men. Flying fish are plentiful in the ocean around Nanumea and for this reason are the most common accompaniment at meals. If there is a fishing competition, especially if done in hoa pairs, that night's catch of flying fish is taken to the āhiga and distributed to the community.

Nohoaga o te Fāoa o te Vaka Kaiva i te Faiva ko te Lalama

- Tae matakatea: ko ia telā e ona te vaka e tafa ki mua
- Tulama: i te galoto kae ki mua (i pō nei koa fakaogā a kasa)
- Tae loto: i te galoto kae ki tua
- Tautai: ki tua loa

Seats of the Crew in Fishing for Flying Fish

- Front net (Tae matakatea): the canoe owner sits in front
- Torch holder (Tūlama): a bit front of center (today a gas lantern is used)
- Center net (Tae loto): a little behind center
- Steersman (Tautai): the furthest back

Te faiva e fai i te pō, telā ko te olo o tae 'have. Kae fai koa tonu me olo o 'lama, koa fano i ai a te tautai o 'hala ia me o fakagū ki tona fāoa māhāni ia lātou e olo o 'lama. Koa kāmata nei o fakatonutonu faka'lei a vaka; fakaholo mai uta o fano ki tai. I te taimi ailoa koa ula i ai, ko te fanake ailoa a te leo mai uta, "A tātou koa ula."

Fishing for flying fish is done at night. On a night when it has been decided to go out fishing, the canoe captain goes to rouse his usual crew. The canoes are arranged in a line extending outwards from the reef fringe. When it is time to light the torches, a voice rings out from shoreward, "We are lighting up."

Koa oti ake nei a vaka ki uta, kae fai e tai patele mālosi a te 'have, a vaka e 'noho ailoa pelā ki te kaulua ia me ko te kautolugalau; koa kamata nei o fai a te vaeveaga a olotou 'have. Koe fai he vaka e kauluagalau mo te matalima, a te pakupaku e 'tau o matalua malima (1:10), kae ko te faifeau e mafai o

The canoes reach the shore at Nanumea. If they have had a good catch of flying fish, one canoe might have two hundred or three hundred fish. The tree donor's share (Te Pakupaku) is 1/10th. The Pastor's share would be about ten. The fishermen divide the remainder among themselves. The captain's share is biggest, followed by the taeloto,

noho pelā ki te matagafulu. Ko te toega koa tufa ia lātou.

then the tūlama and finally the person in the steersman position.

A te Tautai

I fakamatalaga a toeaina o pō mua, a te mea ke fai mo tautai e hē he mea e faigofie. Kae fai koa fatuaki a tou loto ke fai a koe mo tautai, e 'tau mo koe o toka i mea konei:

- ke faite he ou vaka kaiva
- ke toka hoki a tau kofe
- ke iloa e koe o 'fau au pā
- ke iloa hoki e koe o tie, kae 'humu au tae hahave
- pelā hoki mo mea ake (uka, matau, tepe)
- te oho mo mea 'puhi a te fāoa ke toka
- ke lahi a te teateaki o te tautai
- ke tai lahi hoki a tou iloa i muna o te mulivaka

Fishing Captains (Tautai)

As the canoe captains of the past have explained, becoming a tautai is not an easy thing. If you have made up your mind to become a tautai, you will need to prepare or to do all of these things:

- Make your fishing canoe
- Prepare your long fishing rod
- Understand how to make and tie pearl shell lures
- Know how to weave and knot your flying fish nets
- Prepare all the other gear (lines, hooks, coconut shell hooks)
- Prepare chum and bait, and smoking supplies for your crew
- Develop sufficient experience as a captain
- Have a good grasp of canoe handling and the specialized knowledge required

Muna o te Mulivaka

A kāiga takitahi e tofu ailoa mo olotou muna, penei mo te moana. E i ai ailoa ni kāiga e o lātou a muna o te mulivaka. A muna o te poto tenei, "muna o te mulivaka," ni muna e tai faigatā o tuku valevale ki tino. Kae fai he tino e fia fai mālosi ki he mea fakapitoa mai muna o te mulivaka, e mafai a ia o fano o fakamolemole ki te toeaina i te kāiga tenā, fakatahi mo ana mo paka.

"Words from the Canoe Stern" (Muna o te Mulivaka)

Each family has its particular skills, and this goes for the sea also. Some families have special knowledge regarding canoes and fishing. This special knowledge, "words of the canoe stern," is not easily obtained. If someone really wants to learn the specialized knowledge of canoe and fishing lore, he may go to an elder within the family and request this, taking as a small gift of some tobacco.

A mea hoki konei ki hai ni mea hoki e māhāni o fai i te taimi e fai ai a faiva. E iai he hai-atu, hai-pāla, hai-'have mo vaegā hai ake hoki e uke. A te talitonuga tenei ki hai-ika e fai pelā me fakamaina e ia a tou vaka i tona auala ki te moana, kae pelā mo ika kolā ni hai a koe ki ai ka lavea 'mao mai e lātou a tou vaka.

Hai (literally, a special kind of wrapping/tying with cord) is another important practice associated with fishing. There are many kinds of hai, such as hai for bonito, kingfish or flying fish. It is believed that magical tying for fish may illuminate the path of your canoe in the sea, so that the fish you did the tying for will be able to see your canoe from afar.

A tino nāteahō e talitonu kī ki olotou mea konei me ni mea e aogā e tausi ki ai a lātou. E hē motuhia e iai ni tino koi fakaaogā ailoa e lātou a poto konei ke okomai ki pō nei, kae ko te tokoukega koa iloa ake e lātou me ni mea katoa e olotahi mo mea tau aitu. Telā lā a te oko mai o te Lotu, koa fai tenā mo mea ni tiaki i ai e lātou a olotou talitonuga.

People long ago believed strongly in these things because they were useful in providing sustenance. However, the majority knows that these are evil spirit-related things and that in times past much injury resulted from them, including the death of one's children. And so, with the arrival of the Church, those ancient ways and beliefs were largely put aside.

Te Vaevaega o Kainaga o te Faiva

Kae fai e fano a koe ki moana o hīhī atu ia me o 'lama, e iai ailoa ni vaevaega o ika e tau o fakaogā. Mai tafa o kainaga o te fāoa, e lua a kainaga ake e māhāni o fakatoka e te tautai. A te pakupaku he kainaga telā e 'kave ki te tino telā e ana a te lākau ni

Division of the Catch

When you go to sea to pole fish for bonito or to net flying fish, a specific way of dividing up the catch is used. In addition to the shares of the crew, there are two other shares that the captain usually prepares. The pakupaku is a share given to the person whose tree the fishing canoe was made from. The

faite ki ai a te vaka kaiva. A te pakupaku e puke penei: 1/10 i atu mo 'have.

pakupaku consists of 1/10th of the catch of either bonito or flying fish.

Vaega Fauga o Pā

E pelā ailoa mo te mea e iloa fakatahi e tātou, me e tai faigatā ailoa o kai a te ika manafai e māunu ki he fatu me he otaota. Konei a vaega 'faua o pā e māhani o fakaogā e tautai o Nanumea i tauhaga konā koa olo:

- fau Tokelau — atulā he fauga o te pā ni maua mai i Tokelau
- fau a Tetoa — ni maua ailoa i luga o Nanumea
- fau Hamoa — atulā he fauhaga ni maua mai i Samoa
- Fau a Hinoki — ni maua ailoa i luga o Nanumea

Te Pā Hihī Atu

A te mea tenei ko te pā, e noho pelā ki te 3-4 inisi a te loa kae 0.5 inisi a te lauefa. E 'kati mai luga o he feitu tifa telā ni maua i loto o te namo me i moana; koa hoehoe i ai ki he fuaga ki te lahi telā e manako a koe ki ai; koa faka'piki i ai a te maga. Mai lalo o te lou ko 'fau i ai a te hega e faite ki fulu-moa 'tea.

Te Pā Puku

A te uiga o te muna "puku" ko te kai, folo me kāmata ki ni mo meakai; kae ko tona uiga i konei, he pā telā koa oti ni 'fau faka'lei kae tuku i loto i te fāoga. E fakaaogā i te taimi telā e hēai he akau kae manako a te tautai ke maua he pākuaku mā lātou. He matakāiga e tahi i luga o Nanumea e maua i ai a te poto tenei.

Te Pā Māunu

E 'pau ailoa a te fakaaogā o te pā tenei, pā māunu mo te pā puku. E fakaaogā mo halahala a te pakupaku mo fai a te tuiaki manafai e hē taloa a vaka. Ko te pā māunu tenei e fakapogai ki ona fauhaga kolā e 'heke mai fauhaga māhani o pā hihī atu. I te taimi koa fakaaogā i ai, e tū ake a te tautai, 'hai a te pā māunu tenei ki tona kofe. E tahi ailoa a te atu e maua i te pā tenei, kae mafai o fakaola e ia e tahi me lua a vaka kolā e tai pili kia lātou.

Methods of Tying Pearl Shell Lures (Vaega Fauga o Pā)

We all know it is really hard to get fish to bite if the bait is made of rock or garbage. Here are some types of pearl shell lure (pā) tying styles that were used by tautai of Nanumea in times past:

- fau Tokelau — perhaps this tying style came from the Tokelau islands
- fau a Tetoa — found only in Nanumea
- fau Hamoa — perhaps a tying style found in Samoa
- fau a Hinoki — a style found only in Nanumea

Pearl Shell Lure for Bonito (Te Pā Hihī Atu)

A pā is about 3–4 inches long and about ½ inch wide. It is cut out of a piece of pearl shell (tifa) found in the lagoon or in the ocean. This is scraped down on a whetstone to the size desired and then a barb made of coconut shell, or from the shell of a hōpū mollusk, is attached. Below the barb is fashioned the hega, made of white chicken feathers.

The Puku Lure (Te Pā Puku)

The word puku refers to eating or swallowing some food. Here its meaning is a style of lure that is made well but then left in the tackle box. It is used for times when there are no bonito shoals around but the canoe captain wishes to have some bait. Just one family in Nanumea possesses this particular skill.

The Māunu Lure (Te Pā Maunu)

The way this lure is used is exactly like that of the Puku lure. It is used to obtain bait for use in the fishing method called tuiaki pāla. The Māunu lure is well known for its unusual tying style, different from the normal tying style for bonito lures. When this lure is used, the tautai stands up, ties the Māunu lure to his pole, and turns around toward the canoe stern. Just one bonito is caught with this lure, but it will also suffice for the one or two other canoes that are nearby.